

Sydney Sweeney: Rising Star [C1]

Se c'è una cosa che non manca a questo astro nascente del cinema è la determinazione: la ragazza di paese che sognava Hollywood è diventata uno dei volti più riconoscibili del grande schermo.



Hollywood's latest [rising star](#), Sydney Sweeney has been acting since she was twelve years old. Best known for her work in TV series, such as HBO's acclaimed Euphoria and The White Lotus, Sweeney has also made her mark on the big screen, not only as a leading actress but also as a producer. In 2023, she produced and co-starred in the romantic comedy Anyone But You [opposite](#) Glen Powell, a modern [twist](#) on Shakespeare's [Much Ado About Nothing](#) that became a [box office hit](#).

EARLY LIFE

Born and raised in Spokane, Washington, acting once seemed like a far-off dream for Sweeney. But through determination and strategic thinking, she convinced her parents to let her audition for a locally-shot indie film. She [landed](#) the role of Lis, a young girl caught in a zombie [outbreak](#), in the 2009 horror-comedy ZMD: Zombies of Mass Destruction. That same year, she began appearing in television series such as Heroes and Criminal Minds, eventually moving on to more prominent parts in acclaimed series like [The Handmaid's Tale](#) and Sharp Objects.

EUPHORIA

Sweeney's [breakthrough](#) came in 2019 when she was [cast](#) as Cassie Howard in Euphoria, a controversial teen drama that explores addiction, identity, and the complexities of modern relationships. Sweeney's [portrayal](#) of Cassie, a character marked by her vulnerability and emotional intensity, earned her widespread acclaim and Emmy nominations, and captured the attention of Hollywood executives and [casting](#) directors. That same year, she appeared in Quentin Tarantino's [Once Upon a Time in Hollywood](#) as Snake, a member of the Manson Family. Sweeney in series The White Lotus in which she played one of the two wealthy teenagers on holiday with her family.

A FIVE-YEAR PLAN

During a talk at the SXSW festival in Austin, Texas, Sydney Sweeney [recalled](#) how she convinced her parents to support her acting ambitions by delivering a PowerPoint presentation that [mapped out](#) her goals. Growing up in a family with no [ties](#) to the entertainment industry, Sweeney's strategic approach marked the beginning of her career in the film industry. **Sydney Sweeney (American accent):** I was quite young, so I did not know anything about the industry. [I] came from a small town, Spokane, Washington, [that] has nothing to do with this world, and my parents had nothing to do with this world either. And they thought that acting was like wanting to be a princess. It was [unattainable](#), it was just a [far-fetched](#) dream. "She'll come out of it one day." And when I was young, I was, like, ten years old, this really small indie [production] came to town, and I found out

about it. And I [wanted to audition really bad](#), but my parents were like, “What? What’s going on?” So I [put together](#) a five-year business plan presentation of what could happen if they let me audition for this movie. And in it, it had, like, if I audition and I book it, then I’ll meet people on this set that will then introduce me to an agent, and then the agent can get me auditions for commercials and short films, and then maybe I’ll have a [résumé](#), we could go down to LA for pilot season, when pilot season was still a thing. And my parents realised I was pretty serious.

SNL

Although Sweeney admits to experiencing [stage fright](#) during live events, she’s not afraid to take risks. In March 2024, she hosted an episode of Saturday Night Live, the iconic weekly show known for its live performances, quick comedy sketches and real-time audience reactions. **Sydney Sweeney:** It was so scary. My mouth dried up. Oh my gosh, I’m like having panic attacks thinking about it. But it was so much fun. I knew I was going to be terrified going into it, but I wanted to do it because I think it’s important to do things that scare you. I always choose characters because they scare me and they challenge me in new ways. And the whole entire SNL experience was a challenge and it was terrifying. I think it’s good to face fears. I still have the same fear, but I faced it, so... Sweeney making her debut as a Saturday Night Live host in 2024 in which she also took part in a series of sketches.

FROM AUDITIONING TO PRODUCING

After making her producing debut with *Anyone But You*, Sweeney [took on](#) a very different kind of project with *Immaculate*, a psychological horror film set in a remote Italian convent. She not only starred in the film as Sister Cecilia, but also played a key role behind the scenes. Her connection to the story began a decade earlier when she auditioned for the role. **Sydney Sweeney:** The script went into [turnaround](#) and no one ended up making it. So [I] pulled out the [clean draft](#), which is like the first draft. I then started putting the team together. I brought on Dave Bernard, who was a producer on *White Lotus*, and while we were filming season one, Dave was like, “We need to do a horror film”. And I go, “Well, funny you say that. I might have a script.” And so I brought him on and he helped just navigate the whole world, because I have never done anything before. And so we met with financiers, and once we started doing that, we brought on Michael Mohan, our director, and we started working on the script because time has passed and we wanted to update it, also update the character to fit who I am now. I mean, I auditioned hoping I’d get [cast](#) in a movie, and now I look back and I’m like, “Syd, you made it!”. Like, that’s so cool!

EARNING CREDIT

Sweeney says that to her, being a producer means being a part of the project from beginning to end and truly realising the global vision she has for the project.

Sydney Sweeney: To me, being a producer, and [whenever](#) I personally will put my name as a producer on a project, means I'm a part of it from the beginning to the end. I don't want to miss a step, I want to be a part of everything I can put my hands on. I do not like the idea of just putting my name on something and [taking credit where it's not due](#). I want to conceptualise the project and bring it all together. So to me, being a producer is basically like being a parent and helping a project grow. People

How Taylor Swift Conquered the World In un contesto mediatico polarizzato, l'artista del Tennessee trascende il mondo dello spettacolo. Taylor Swift è la stella più brillante del pop e rappresenta un fenomeno generazionale che definisce una nuova era della cultura popolare. Molly Malcolm

THE PROCESS

Every actor has their own approach to acting, and Sydney Sweeney's is slightly more unconventional than you might expect. **Sydney Sweeney:** This is probably so controversial, but I don't like to [rehearse](#). I don't like to plan things, I don't like to have anything set. I like to just know what's my space that I can work in, where's the cameras, and let's just see what happens. Sometimes actors and filmmakers don't like that, and so I have to, like, work with it.

ANYTHING AND EVERYTHING

As she moves forward in her career, Sydney Sweeney says she will keep looking out for characters that challenge her, and she will keep looking for ways to tell stories that she feels need to be told. **Sydney Sweeney:** It's just whether the story makes you either question things or excites me or challenges me. It's truly just, "Do I think that this will be a conversation piece for people? Do I think that this will make people feel a certain way?" It's what I was saying about being challenged, making sure that I'm finding characters that challenge me in different ways, different stories to tell. I want to play anything and everything that people won't expect me to do.

SYDNEY SWEENEY'S GENES

In the summer of 2025, Sweeney starred in an ad campaign for a [denim](#) brand with the slogan "Sydney Sweeney Has Great Jeans," playing on the homophony between 'jeans' and 'genes'. As Sweeney is a blonde-haired, blue-eyed white

woman, many viewers interpreted the ad as promoting genetic superiority, viewing the wordplay as a [dog whistle](#) for far-right ideologies. The [backlash](#) intensified when it was revealed that she had registered as a Republican voter in 2024, leading some to label her “MAGA Barbie.” Even Donald Trump praised the campaign, calling it the “HOTTEST ad out there.” Sweeney has repeatedly declined to comment, stating she is “not here to talk about politics” and simply wants to “make art.” Arts and politics aside, the controversy has been a very successful publicity [stunt](#). Sydney Sweeney in Euphoria, in which she plays a teenager with a reputation for promiscuity.

SPACE ADVENTURER OR BOND GIRL?

Sydney Sweeney’s 2026 is packed with major projects. Her latest release, [The Housemaid](#), is a psychological thriller based on Freida McFadden’s bestselling novel. Sweeney plays Millie, a young woman with a troubled past who works for a wealthy couple, played by Amanda Seyfried and Brandon Sklenar. What begins as a dream job quickly [spirals into](#) a dangerous game of secrets and power. She also appears in the upcoming third season of Euphoria, which is set to [premiere](#) this month. Among her upcoming roles is Barbarella, a remake of the 1968 sci-fi cult classic. In the original film, Jane Fonda played a space adventurer sent to save the galaxy. A teaser trailer has confirmed Sweeney’s involvement in the project, a retro-futuristic adventure with Sweeney [stepping into the iconic role](#). Meanwhile, rumours continue to circulate about Sweeney’s potential involvement in a new James Bond movie. She has [acknowledged](#) the speculation but clarified that no official [casting](#) decisions have been made. Asked if she’d like to play a Bond girl, Sweeney said in a recent interview: “I think I’d have more fun as James Bond.” Casting for the next [installment](#) is expected to begin later this year.

Glossary

- **dog whistle** = messaggio in codice
- **Housemaid** = domestica
- **where it's not due** = quando non è meritato
- **box office hit** = successo al botteghino
- **Once Upon a Time** = c'era una volta
- **unattainable** = irrealizzabile
- **wanted to audition really bad** = desiderare qualcosa intensamente
- **put together** = mettere insieme
- **whenever** = ogni volta che, quando
- **backlash** = reazione negativa
- **rising star** = stella nascente
- **stage fright** = paura del palcoscenico
- **turnaround** = sospensione
- **taking credit** = prendersi il merito
- **stepping into the iconic role** = entrare nel ruolo, vestire i panni di
- **acknowledged** = riconoscere, ammettere
- **breakthrough** = svolta, primo grande successo
- **denim** = jeans
- **twist** = svolta, variante
- **landed** = ottenere, riuscire a ottenere
- **installment** = capitolo, episodio di una saga
- **outbreak** = epidemia, focolaio
- **recalled** = ricordare
- **clean draft** = bozza iniziale
- **cast** = scegliere per il ruolo
- **far-fetched** = inverosimile
- **résumé** = CV
- **spirals into** = degenerare in
- **premiere** = debuttare, uscire
- **opposite** = recitare con
- **portrayal** = interpretazione
- **mapped out** = delineare, tracciare
- **ties** = legami
- **took on** = intraprendere
- **stunt** = trovata pubblicitaria
- **Much Ado About Nothing** = “Molto rumore per nulla”
- **The Handmaid's Tale** = “Il racconto dell'ancella”
- **rehearse** = provare, fare le prove